

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with a year of legal placement experience at a major international law firm (BCLP), supporting complex international arbitration and real estate disputes matters. Experienced in document review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural drafting, case-file organisation and deadline management across multiple concurrent matters. Developing interest in private equity and investment funds, explored through an A&O Shearman open day, a Coursera private equity course and the Clifford Chance Real Estate Finance programme. Currently advising clients on live matters at Citizens Advice East Berkshire and completing an LLM in Comparative and International Dispute Resolution at Queen Mary University of London.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**
Queen Mary University of London

- International arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**
University College London

- Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**
King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**
Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; amended sections of the memorial and drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Became the sole junior supporting the team before a significant submission deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time delivery
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines across the matter
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**
Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines, maintaining matter records via iManage

- Assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from instruction to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines independently
- Interviews clients, takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues across welfare, employment, housing, family and debt matters
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's personal data and adtech; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; document review; electronic bundling; drafting procedural and correspondence documents; iManage; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across multiple concurrent matters; developing knowledge of private equity fund structures and investment mechanics (Coursera PE course; Clifford Chance Real Estate Finance programme)